

Core Mechanics:

- **Shared Mindplay:** Player and protagonist inhabit the same vessel. The protagonist occasionally aids or obstructs the player, creating a dynamic and unpredictable gameplay experience.
- **Idiom-Based Challenges:** Each “act” is inspired by a common saying, turned into interactive puzzles, environmental hazards, and combat sequences.
- **Exploration & Discovery:** Players navigate stages filled with hidden details, narrative cues, and fantastical anomalies that challenge perception.
- **Chaos System:** The stage itself manipulates gameplay—props, lighting, NPC behavior, and physics dynamically shift to keep the player on edge.
- **Humor & Storytelling:** Comedy arises from absurd interactions, playful NPCs, and subverted expectations.

Game Structure with Adjusted Idioms

Act I – “Curiosity Killed the Cat” → “The Devil is in the Details”

- **Theme:** Temptation, Risk, and Unease
 - **Setting:** Ruined mansion in an otherwise normal city; small anomalies hint reality is off.
 - **Danger Element:** Player discovers cryptic evidence of a paranoid serial killer; small details hide major threats.
 - **Thrill:** The killer’s paranoia triggers mini-chases and sudden traps in the environment.
 - **Comedy:** Impossible room layouts and absurd environmental quirks (floating furniture, talking cats) lighten tension.
 - **Brainstorm Tie-In:** Introduces the serial killer and subtle reality cracks.
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Act II – “Don’t Go Poking the Bear” → “Let Sleeping Secrets Lie”

- **Theme:** Restraint, Hidden Dangers, Suspicion
 - **Setting:** Forest that shifts subtly as you explore; shadows hint at the killer lurking nearby.
 - **Danger Element:** Disturbing secrets (evidence, clues) awakens danger, including hallucinations or traps.
 - **Thrill:** Stealth, careful exploration, and puzzle-solving to avoid alerting threats.
 - **Comedy:** Whispering trees and absurd animal commentary poke fun at player’s caution.
 - **Brainstorm Tie-In:** Reality begins leaking subtly; protagonist intervenes to misdirect or assist.
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Act III – “The Straw That Broke the Camel’s Back” → “Walking on Thin Ice”

- **Theme:** Burden, Anxiety, and Paranoia
 - **Setting:** Canyon bridge overloaded with treasure and clues about the killer.
 - **Danger Element:** Environmental collapse triggered by weight; the killer’s paranoia produces sudden ambushes.
 - **Thrill:** Dynamic chase where the player must throw off excess items while evading threats.
 - **Comedy:** Camel NPC heckles player (“Careful, this bridge isn’t insured!”).
 - **Brainstorm Tie-In:** Shared-mind mechanic intensifies; player feels protagonist’s influence in stress-filled decisions.
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Act IV – “Don’t Count Your Chickens Before They Hatch” → “All That Glitters is Not Gold”

- **Theme:** Overconfidence & Deception
 - **Setting:** Village stage with glowing treasures and red herrings; hallucinations appear as clues to the serial killer’s pattern.
 - **Danger Element:** Glittering objects hide hazards; illusions mislead the player.
 - **Thrill:** Puzzle-solving and combat where items can be traps or rewards; chasing clues to uncover killer’s identity.
 - **Comedy:** NPCs act oblivious or absurdly casual (“Oh, don’t mind that glowing thing—it’s probably safe”).
 - **Brainstorm Tie-In:** Reality cracks intensify; hallucinations blur lines between clue and threat.
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Act V – “Let Sleeping Dogs Lie” → “Opening Pandora’s Box”

- **Theme:** Curiosity, Restraint, and Fear
- **Setting:** Dungeon filled with spectral hounds guarding both treasure and critical evidence.
- **Danger Element:** Noise, greed, or hallucinations awaken spectral hounds and trigger killer encounters.
- **Thrill:** Survival horror-style sequence requiring timing, stealth, and quick decision-making.
- **Comedy:** Dogs bicker absurdly even as they attack (“I told you, I hate being chained near treasure!”).
- **Brainstorm Tie-In:** Shared-mind tension peaks; protagonist occasionally misleads or protects the player.

Act VI – “All the World’s a Stage” → “The Show Must Go On”

- **Theme:** Chaos, Confrontation, and Performance
 - **Setting:** Chaotic stage merging all prior acts; hazards, hallucinations, and killer traps converge.
 - **Danger Element:** Director manipulates stage; all previous dangers collide.
 - **Thrill:** Multi-genre climax combining combat, puzzles, survival, and chase sequences.
 - **Comedy:** NPCs from earlier acts appear mid-chaos in absurd costumes or roles.
 - **Emotion:** Player gains ability to bend idioms/reality to survive—turning the chaos into agency.
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Finale – “Home Is Where the Heart Is” → “Face the Music”

- **Theme:** Choice, Belonging, and Agency
- **Setting:** Backstage corridor fading into personal world; reality begins stabilizing.
- **Danger Element:** Audience projects chaos metaphorically; killer threat neutralized or escaped.
- **Thrill:** Last improv act: dodge environmental hazards and resolve lingering hallucinations.
- **Comedy:** Hecklers and props misfire in absurd ways.
- **Emotion:** Player and protagonist walk away into their own world, reclaiming agency.